DPP	DEPARTMENT POLICY AND PROCEDURE		
Title	**HANDOVER OF PATIENT TO LOWER ACUITY OF CARE**		
Department	**Pediatric Intensive Care Unit**		
Applies to	**All PICU Medical and Nursing Staff**		
Policy Code and Version Number	**DPP-PICU-014 (v3)**		
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1.0 PURPOSE

1.1. To provide guidelines on how to handover patient from PICU to ward.

1.2. To ensure the continuity of care after receiving the patient in the ward.

1.3. To provide a consistent framework for the communication of important patient information during handover of patients from Pediatric Intensive Care Unit (PICU) to a lower acuity of care/ward to ensure and maintain continuity of care.

2.0 DEFINITION/ABBREVIATION

2.1. **Handover of Care:** a process when the passing of patient specific information occurs from one care-giver to another or from one department to another. A handover also includes transferring the responsibility of care from one care-giver to another

2.2. **Transfer from ICU to Ward:** refers to the transport of patient when intensive care management is no longer indicated to patient condition.

3.0 RESPONSIBILITY

3.1 **Head of PICU** is responsible for ensuring that patient meets the criteria of discharge/transfer before transporting the patient to ward.

3.2 **PICU Physicians (Residents, Specialist, Consultant)** must provide a written order for transfer of patient to ward.

3.3 **PICU Nurse (Head nurse, Charge nurse, Staff nurse)** confirms the availability of bed in the ward prior to shifting the patient.

3.3.1. The nurse will inform the Patient-Relation Officer to ask the parents to come to PICU to allow the mother to stay with the patient in the ward.

3.3.2. The nurse is responsible to transfer the patient from PICU to ward with proper endorsement given to the HN/CN of the unit.

3.4. **Ward Nurse** prepares the bed and the machines needed prior to receiving the patient in the unit.

4.0 POLICY

4.1. Mikhwa General Hospital Pediatric Intensive Care Unit shall establish a guideline for handover procedures between staff at the time of patient discharge/transfer to a lower acuity of care/ward.

4.1. Transfer of patient to the ward will be based from the PICU Admission and Discharge Criteria policy.

4.2. The PICU physician and nurse must completely write the PICU Internal transfer prior to shifting the patient to ward.

4.3. The transferring and receiving nurse and physician must both sign in the PICU Internal Transfer forms accordingly after endorsement that will serve as evidence for handover care.

4.4. The PICU nurse will give complete endorsement to the ward nurse with emphasis on:

4.4.1. Patient's complete data

4.4.2. Patient's admitting diagnosis

4.4.3. Latest vital signs

4.4.4. Current medications

4.4.5. Medications previously received

4.4.6. Laboratory investigations sent and to be done

4.4.7. Any diagnostic procedure done (Ultrasound, X-ray, CT, MRI) etc.

4.4.8. Any consultations done (Ophthalmology, Dermatology) etc.

4.5. Parents will be notified about the transfer of patient to ward through designated office (Patient Experience Department).

5.0 PROCEDURE (S)

5.1. The Chief of PICU along with the PICU physicians will assess the patient if qualifies for Discharge criteria to facilitate transfer of patient to the ward if cannot be directly discharge from PICU.

5.2. The PICU Physician on-call will write the order of transfer in the order sheet and will fill up the PICU Internal transfer form.

5.3. The PICU nurse will fill up the PICU Internal Transfer Form and confirm first by calling the receiving ward nurse for the availability of bed in the ward.

5.4. If bed is available, then the PICU nurse will call the Patient Experience Officer to inform the parents to come to PICU to start the transfer procedure.

5.5. Inform the NOD in the ward about the patient's present condition, take the possible room number and verify with the ward HN or CN about the time of transfer.

5.6. Once the parents arrived in PICU, confirm their identity and advise them to go to the ward to allow the mother to stay in the specified room number.

5.7. Check the completeness of the patient's medical file.

5.8. Prepare the patient and the machines needed for transport if necessary.

5.9. The assigned PICU nurse will transport the patient to the specified ward via open crib or hospital bed.

5.10. The PICU nurse will give complete and proper endorsement to the ward nurse according to policy.

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5.11. PICU nurse should re-emphasize the health teachings given to parents which starts from admission time.

5.12. After transfer of patient, the PICU nurse will clean the hospital bed/crib and machines according to infection control policy as soon as possible for the next admission.

5.13. Discard all materials used by the patient according to policy.

5.14. Record the patient's transfer data in the Bed Management Logbook and submit to nursing supervisor.

5.15. Transfer patient's bed account to the ward through MOH Bed Management System.

5.16. Record all the relevant information of patient transfer in the PICU Admission/Discharge logbook.

6.0 EQUIPMENTS

6.1. PICU Physicians internal transfer / discharge form(GDOH-INP-INITD-125)

6.2. PICU Nurses Internal transfer / Discharge Form (GDOH-INP-IPTD-151)

7.0 ATTACHMENT/FORMS

7.1. N/A

8.0 REFERENCES

8.1. MOH Guidelines for Pediatric Care

8.2. DPP-PICU-0002(V2) – Handover of patient from PICU to ward – PMSH, 01/10/1441

8.3. Saudi Central Board for Accreditation of Healthcare Institution (CBAHI) PICU standards, 3rd version, January 2016

9.0 REVISION CLAUSE

9.1. Used the new logo for AL-Baha Health Cluster.

9.2. Modify the policy and procedure lay out, changed the content of the Header and footer